CARE TRANSITION EFFICIENCY & PLACEMENT OUTCOME ANALYTICS

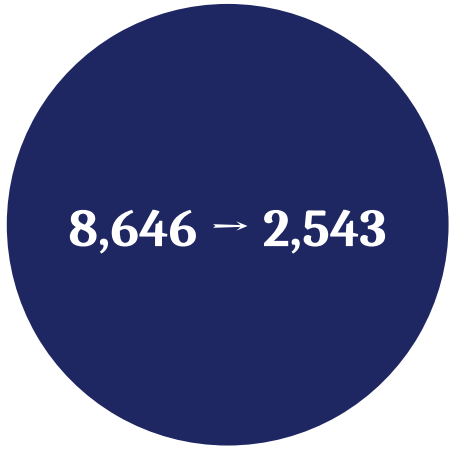
A process-efficiency analysis of the HHS Unaccompanied Alien Children Program

January 12, 2023 – December 21, 2025 | 720 daily reports analyzed

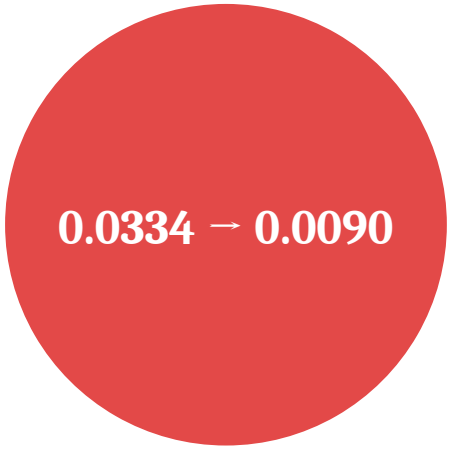
Prepared for HHS / Unified Mentor Internship Program

The Program Looks Smaller — Not More Efficient

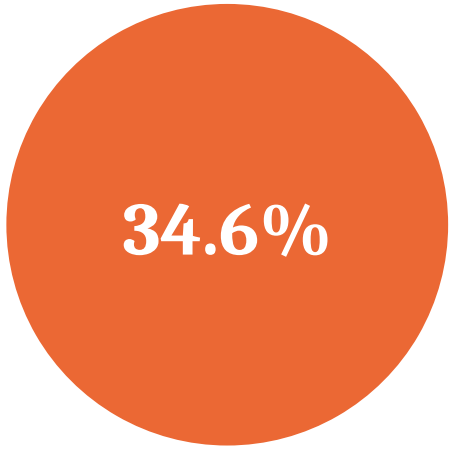
Three numbers from the reporting period



Avg. children in HHS care, 2023 vs 2025



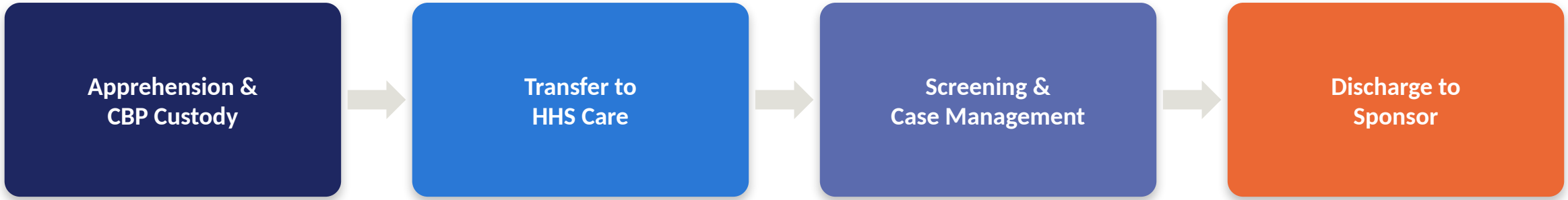
Avg. Discharge Effectiveness Index, 2023 vs 2025



of all reports fall inside an active backlog-accumulation window

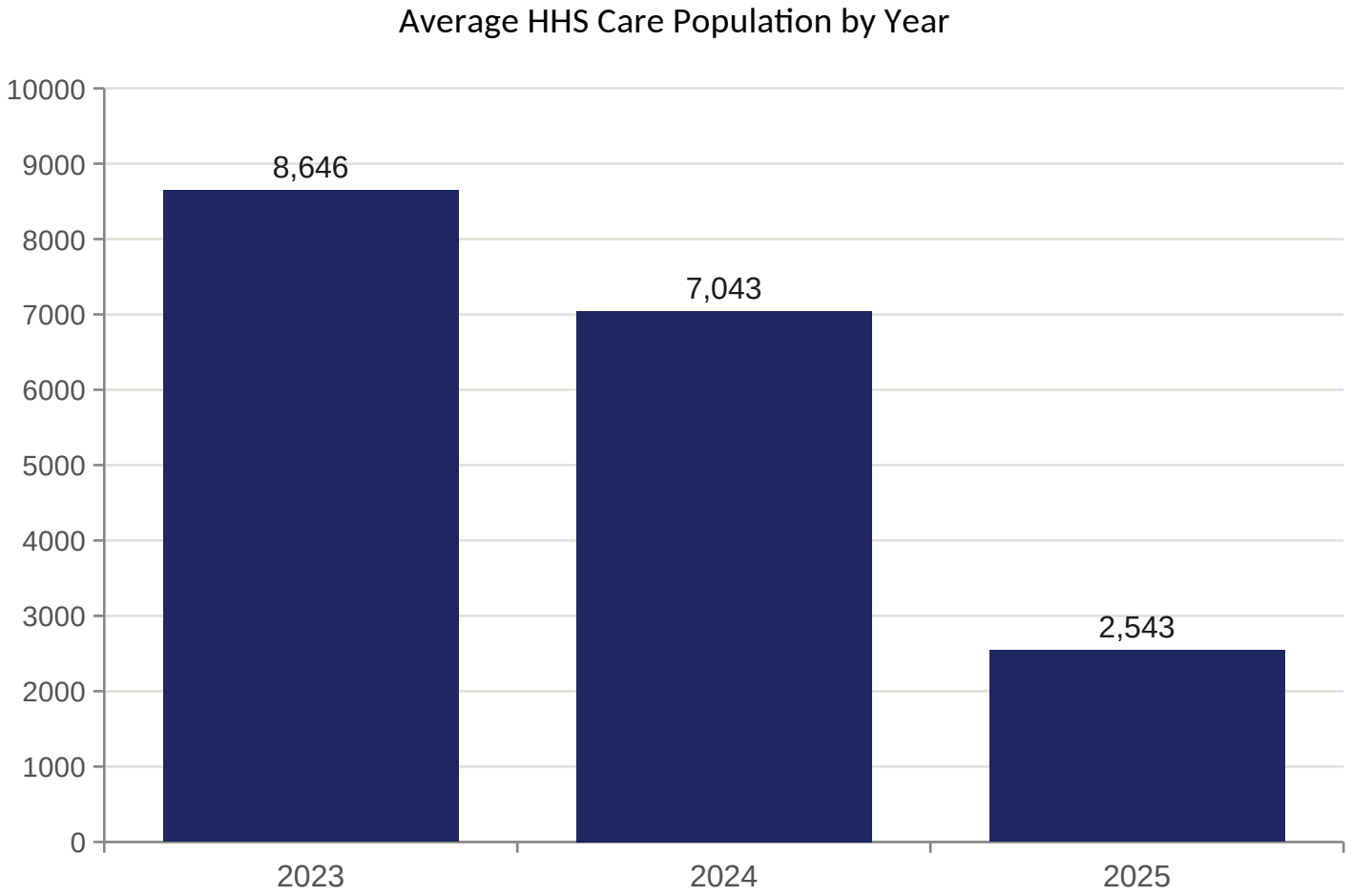
The active care population fell by more than 70% — but discharge effectiveness fell too. The decline reflects fewer new arrivals, not a faster reunification pipeline.

The Care Pipeline



This report measures the speed and reliability of movement between stages — not just how many children occupy each one at a point in time.

Active Population Fell Sharply in Early 2025

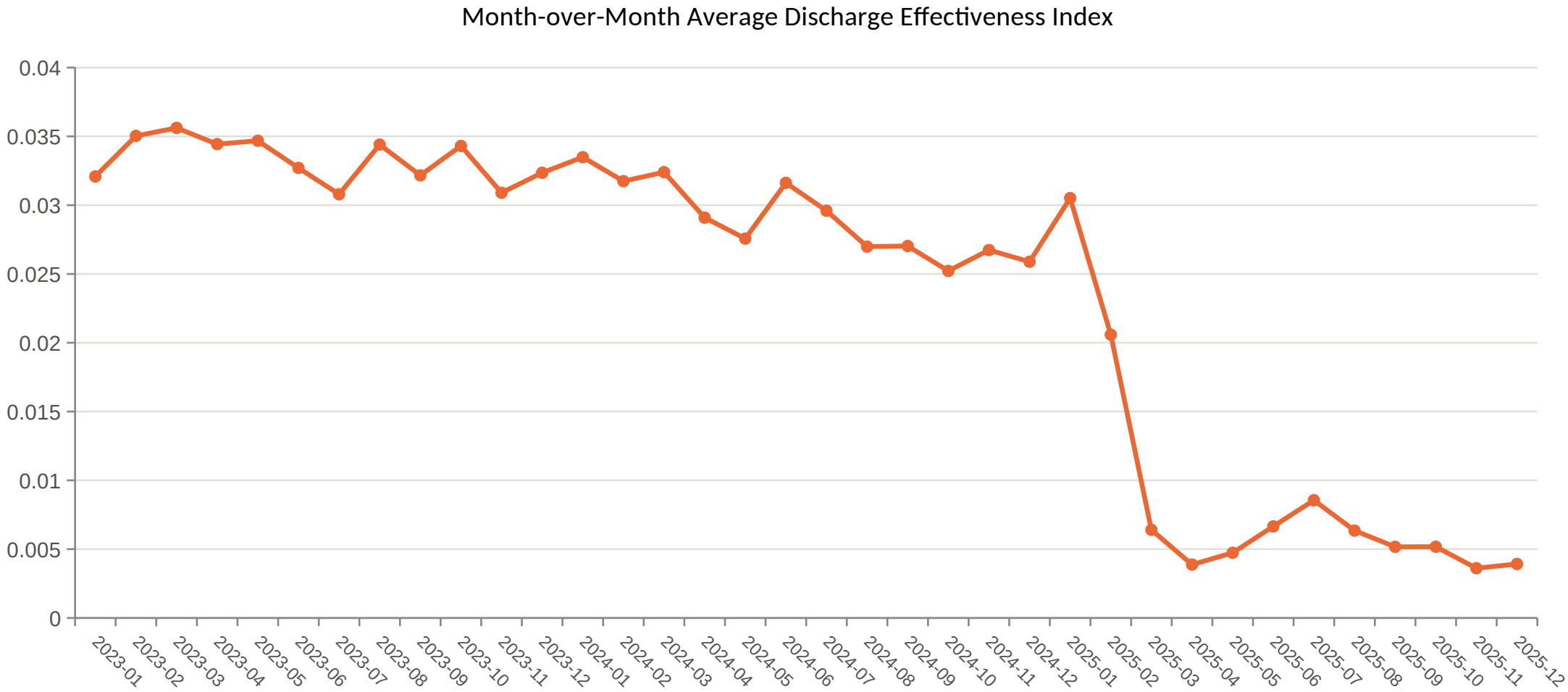


8,646
average children in HHS care, 2023

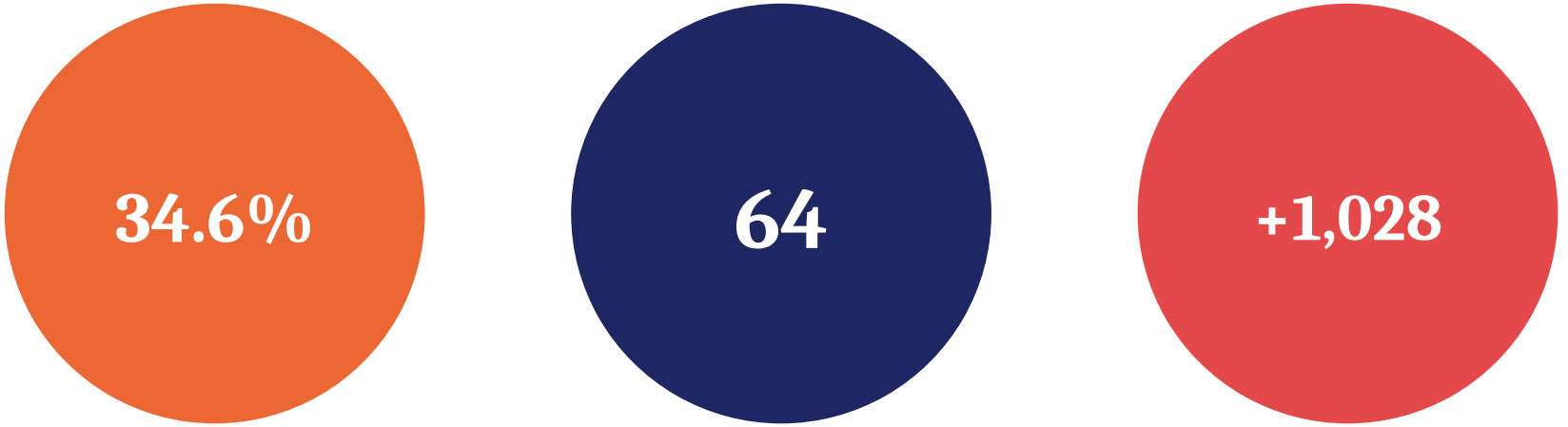
2,543
average children in HHS care, 2025

−70.6%
year-over-year change

Discharge Effectiveness Has Not Kept Pace



More Than a Third of Reports Show an Active Backlog



of reports fall in an active backlog-accumulation window

report longest streak (September 29 – December 30, 2024)

peak 14-day net inflow (May 02, 2024)

Backlog-clearing (net outflow) dominated 2023–2024. The shift to the smaller 2025 population coincides with backlog-building episodes in mid-to-late 2024 — not with a more effective discharge process.

The Central Finding

A smaller population is not the same as a healthier pipeline.

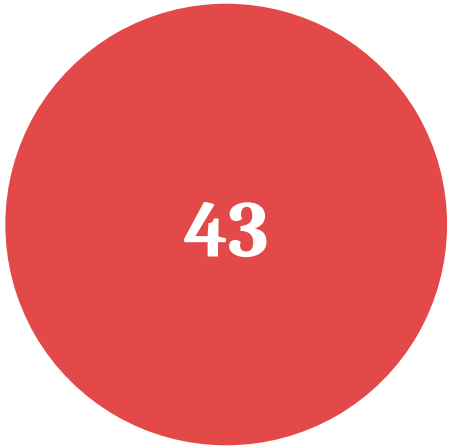
The 2025 drop in HHS care population is best explained by fewer new arrivals into the system — not by faster, more effective discharges. Discharge Effectiveness fell alongside the population, not against it.

Recommended next step: separate root-cause analysis of intake volume vs. discharge-process performance — the two are currently conflated in headline reporting.

Placement Outcomes Are Moderately Volatile



average Outcome Stability Score
(30-day rolling CV)



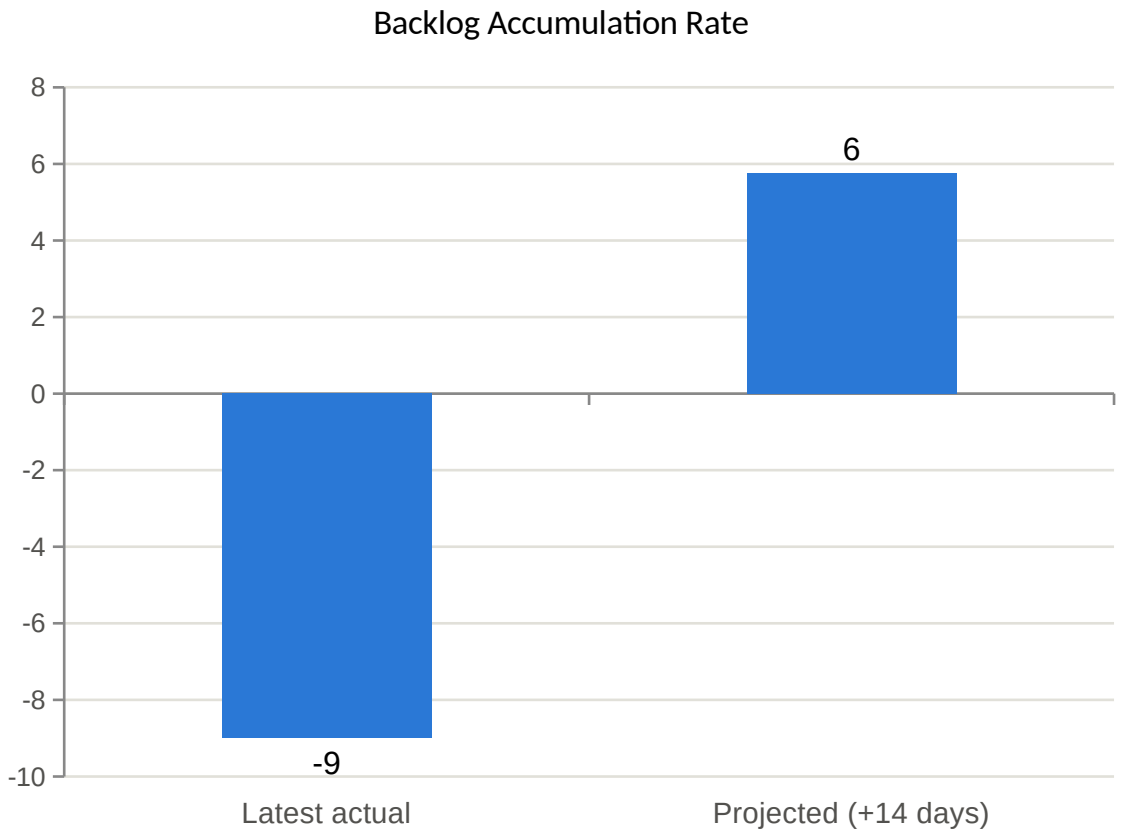
reports exceeded the
0.5 volatility threshold

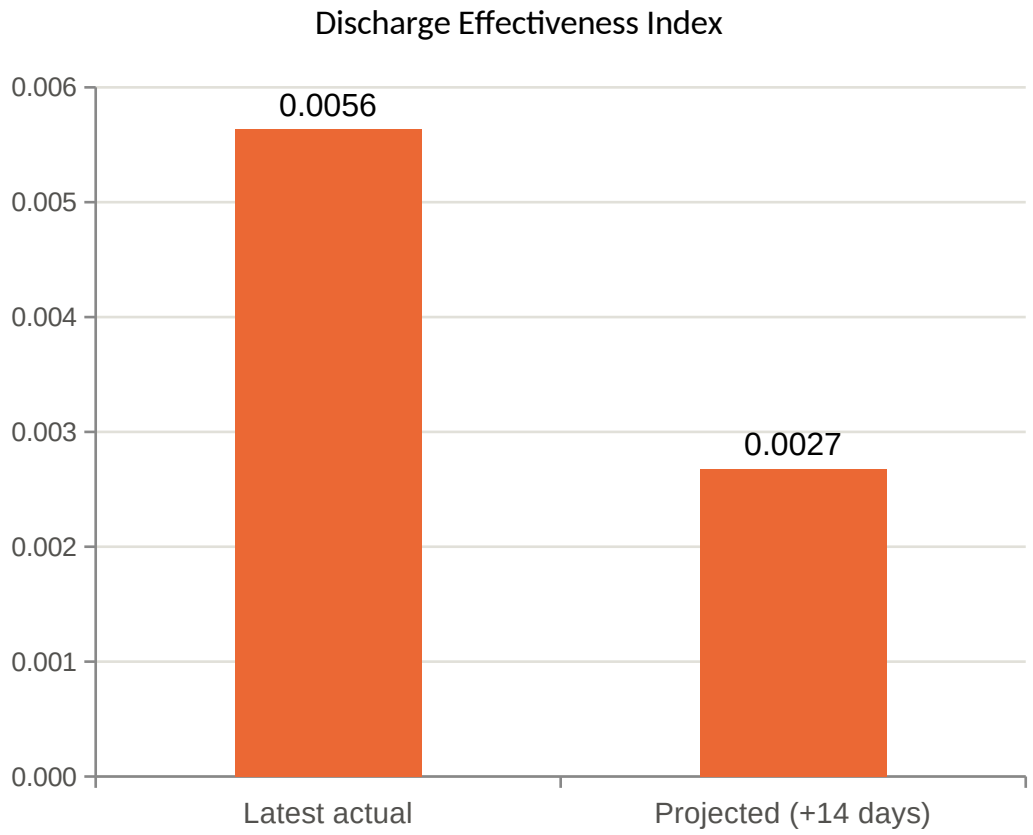


weekend vs. weekday gap
in Discharge Effectiveness

Lower is more consistent. A coefficient of variation near zero means discharge performance barely changed month to month; higher values mark stretches worth a closer case-management review.

Both Signals Point the Same Direction Into 2026





Directional trend projection only (simple linear fit, trailing 60 days) — not a validated forecast. Shown as an early-warning signal, not a prediction to plan around.

Recommendations

1

Separate root-cause analysis

Investigate the Discharge Effectiveness decline independently from the population decline — they are not the same signal.

2

Monitor backlog reversal

Stand up automated alerting on Backlog Accumulation Rate turning positive for 2+ consecutive weeks.

3

Clarify the apprehension footnote

Confirm the exact definition of the footnoted CBP-custody metric with HHS before external use.

4

Review weekday/weekend staffing

A modest but consistent discharge-effectiveness gap favors weekends — worth a staffing-pattern review.

5

Standardize reporting cadence

Document gap-handling explicitly to improve the precision of future rate-based KPIs.

Questions & Discussion

Full methodology, KPI definitions, and detailed findings are available in the accompanying research paper.